

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 12

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Sergeant Rick N. Finley of Selmer.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their own concerns to ensure our collective freedom and personal safety; in providing for the domestic tranquility of the community as a whole, society recognizes the need for a system of laws; and

WHEREAS, the enforcement of the law has been entrusted to a small number of dedicated individuals who face daily the rigors of human conflict in protecting those whom they so selflessly serve; and

WHEREAS, the people of Tennessee are fortunate to be served by the brave and dedicated law enforcement officers who put their lives on the line while carrying out their essential duties; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant Rick N. Finley of Selmer was one such outstanding and heroic public servant, who gave his life while serving his fellow citizens on December 14, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant Rick Finley was born in Savannah on February 26, 1985, to Terry Finley and Robbin Reinhardt; and

WHEREAS, at the young age of only sixteen, he embarked on a journey in mixed martial arts, ultimately earning a sixth-degree black belt; his dedication to this endeavor exemplified his relentless spirit and grit that defined his life; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant Finley served his country as a member of the U.S. Army National Guard for six years, undertaking two deployments to Iraq; upon his honorable discharge, he channeled his love for service into a career in law enforcement; and

WHEREAS, on November 8, 2011, he joined the McNairy County Sheriff's Office as a full-time deputy, proudly serving there while also contributing part time to the Selmer Police Department; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant Rick Finley was a beacon of selflessness, kindness, bravery, and humility; he was proud to serve his community and wholly committed himself to protecting his friends and neighbors, bringing joy to all who were blessed to know him; and

WHEREAS, he was also deeply devoted to his family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his father, Sergeant Finley is survived by his loving wife, Amber Finley; his children: Christen Young, Mitchell (Kalie) Finley, Caiman Finley, and Ronin Finley, due in March 2025; and his grandchild, Alias Young; and

WHEREAS, he is further survived by his grandmother, Linda Priest; brother, Timothy (Jessica) Lard; nephew, Jayden Lard; niece, Jaycee Lard; special friends, Craig and Willette Hamm; mother-in-law, Kimberly Ballard; and an extensive family of loved ones, friends, and colleagues from his law enforcement and National Guard family; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his mother, Sergeant Finley was preceded in death by his son, Kai T. Finley, and father-in-law, Jon Ballard; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant Rick Finley leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity, probity, and valor in his public life as a law enforcement officer, compassion and loyalty in private life, and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the too brief yet bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH
GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF

REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the life of Sergeant Rick N. Finley of Selmer, reflecting fondly upon his character and his commitment to public service.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.